



DR. RAMESH KANCHARLA

CHAIRMAN & MANAGING DIRECTOR,
RAINBOW CHILDREN'S HOSPITALS

(FY26 REVENUE: ₹1,703 CR)

Paediatrician Dr. Ramesh Kancharla founded Rainbow Children's Hospital in Hyderabad in 1999, after identifying a clear need for dedicated tertiary care focused specifically on women and children. Trained in paediatric gastroenterology, hepatology and nutrition in the UK, he returned to India to build a specialised institution centred on paediatrics, neonatology and maternal care, at a time when few Indian hospitals offered this level of dedicated focus. Under his leadership, Rainbow expanded from its Hyderabad origins into a multi-city network across India, while continuing to invest in neonatal intensive care, paediatric surgery, fetal medicine and high-risk obstetrics.

cities could not pay for good treatment was never true. "The issue is that you do not have the availability of the service."

Paras now runs around 2,100 beds across eight hospitals, with another 800 due in Ludhiana and an expanded Gurugram campus. Dr. Nagar has spent years preparing the company for a public listing by bringing in institutional investors such as Creador, 360 ONE and Axis AIF, building an independent board with senior figures from other large corporations, and running external audits well ahead of any formal requirement to do so. That preparation reached a formal milestone in June 2026, when Paras refiled its draft prospectus for a roughly ₹1,800 crore IPO, its second attempt after an earlier ₹400 crore filing cleared SEBI in 2024 but lapsed before the company could launch it. He still holds more than 70% of the business himself.

Magar has stayed regional by design. "Healthcare will always be a regional play," he says. "It is not a national play. India is not a country, India is a subcontinent." Even on acquisitions, an avenue Paras has not used so far unlike many listed rivals, Dr. Nagar is selective about

what he calls brand-stamping, saying flatly that he does not believe in "stamping buildings with our brand name" without first bringing the infrastructure, equipment and culture up to standard.

A doctor by training, Dr. Ranjan Pai, Chairman of Manipal Education and Medical Group (MEMG), has overseen the transformation of Manipal Hospitals from a single hospital into one of India's largest private healthcare networks through a combination of greenfield expansion, acquisitions and long-term institutional capital. While his father, Dr. Ramdas Pai, laid the foundation by building the Manipal education and healthcare institutions, Dr. Pai expanded the group's healthcare business by introducing professional management, attracting private equity and pursuing strategic acquisitions.

Under his leadership, Manipal Hospitals acquired Columbia Asia and, more recently, Sahyadri Hospitals. Dr. Pai believes clinical leadership must eventually be complemented by professional management. "Most of the large hospital chains started with doctors, and I think that can be a strength initially. Over time, though, it should not become a hindrance."